



Colorado State Committee Meeting – January 6, 2026

Executive Session Minutes

Meeting Place: Via TEAMS

Members Present: Jerry Sonnenberg, Acting STC

Staff Present: Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director
Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief
Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief
Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist
Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist
Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist
Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist
Woody Woods, District Director
Scott Brase, District Director
Sam Montoya, District Director
Jon Weishaar, District Director

Guests: None

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on January 4, 2026, Via TEAMS, Jerry Sonnenberg, Acting STC opened the Executive Session at 2:45 p.m.

2. Conservation Reserve Program (CRP)

A 321 Equitable Relief – Misaction/Misinformation – Saguache – CREP SU 61 – Darwin Enszt

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the Acting STC with the case file (Exhibit 1) to review and make a determination on requesting Equitable Relief under Misaction/Misinformation to DAFP for Darwin L. Enszt on a Rio Grande CREP SU61 offer submitted on Tract 960 consisting of 121.92 acres. This request of equitable relief is to allow the CRP-1 be approved with an effective date of June 1, 2024.

Saguache County producer Darwin L. Enszt submitted a Continuous CRP Signup 61 CREP Colorado III-Rio Grande offer for tract 960 on May 6, 2024.

The Saguache County FSA office signed and approved the CRP-1 on May 6, 2024.

It was later discovered by the DD that the county acted improperly while processing the CRP-1:

1. Erroneously approved CRP-1 on paper
 - a. Conservation plans was not signed and on file prior to approval
 - b. FSA-941 was not signed and on file prior to approval
2. County office did not timely load CRP-1 approval date into the COLS software.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 1), the Acting STC determined this case meets the criteria for equitable relief under Misaction/misinformation and is not within the STC authority. Acting STC approved to submit a recommendation to DAFP that equitable relief under Misaction/misinformation be granted on the Rio Grande CREP SU61 offer submitted on Tract 960 for Darwin L. Ensz.

B 321 Equitable Relief – Misaction/Misinformation – Saguache – CREP SU 61 – Gene Ensz

Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist, presented the Acting STC with the case file (Exhibit 2) to review and make a determination on requesting Equitable Relief under Misaction/Misinformation to DAFP for Gene Ensz on a Rio Grande CREP SU61 offer submitted on Tract 946 consisting of 126.15 acres. This request of equitable relief is to allow the CRP-1 be approved with an effective date of July 1, 2024.

Saguache County producer Gene Ensz submitted a Continuous CRP Signup 61 CREP Colorado III-Rio Grande offer for tract 946 on June 28, 2024.

The Saguache County FSA office signed and approved the CRP-1 on June 28, 2024.

It was later discovered by the DD that the county acted improperly while processing the CRP-1:

1. Erroneously approved CRP-1 on paper
 - a. Conservation plans was not signed and on file prior to approval
 - b. FSA-941 was not signed and on file prior to approval
2. County office did not timely load CRP-1 approval date into the COLS software.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 2), the Acting STC determined this case meets the criteria for equitable relief under Misaction/misinformation and is not within the STC authority. Acting STC approved to submit a recommendation to DAFP that equitable relief under Misaction/misinformation be granted on the Rio Grande CREP SU61 offer submitted on Tract 946 for Gene Ensz.

3. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A 321 Equitable Relief – Programmatic Relief – Moffat – McStay Brothers – 23 Late Filed AFC

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the Acting STC with the case file (Exhibit 3) to review and make a determination on Moffat County COC request for Equitable Relief under programmatic relief to DAFP on a 2023 NAP late filed CCC-576 part D through H (Application for Payment (AFP)) for McStay Brothers.

Moffat County is requesting programmatic relief on 2023 late-filed applications for payments. 1-NAP (Rev. 2) subparagraph 675B states that an application for payment is considered filed when the CCC-576 part H has been signed by the producer and is accompanied by all required documentation. In this case the producer late filed the CCC-576 part H and supporting CCC-452 (actual production history-APH) on:

- CCC-576 part H Rye Fg filed 7/8/25 (556 days after the 12/30/23 deadline)
- CCC-576 part H Rye Gr filed 6/6/25 (524 days after the 12/30/23 deadline)
- CCC-452 APH Rye Fg and Gr filed 6/6/25 (524 days after the 12/30/23 deadline)

Application for Payment (AFP)

An application for payment is considered filed according to 1-NAP (Rev. 2) paragraph 675 when both of the following apply: Part H has been signed by the producer and it is accompanied by all required documentation for the unit, including but not limited to : an acceptable report of acreage, an acceptable CCC-576, Part B notice of loss, acceptable production evidence, any other documentation and information necessary from the applicant for COC to determine the correct payment amount. CCC-576 Parts D through H is complete and part H is signed by the producer. In addition, a prior years premium must be paid before the application for payment deadline, if a prior year's premium is not satisfied before the application for payment deadline, the application for payment will be disapproved.

Authority to grant relief is under DAFP authority 8.5E late filed AFP exceeds 365 calendar days. The AFP is 524 days late based on the STC normal harvest date and 679 days late based on the final appraisal or abandonment/end of harvest of the crop.

Program participants are entitled to program payments and decisions on program payments including decisions on whether they qualify and meet program requirements, or when they file a valid application. Relief, or even the consideration of relief by FSA, is discretionary. Participants are not "entitled" to relief. Relief is not a program, program benefit, or entitlement.

A key item to consider when deciding whether to exercise discretion to consider relief is if the relief would make the participant better off than someone who fully complied or met all program requirements, followed the rules, or qualified or satisfied all conditions for payment.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 5), the Acting STC determined this case does not meet the criteria for equitable relief under programmatic relief based on the erroneous findings documented in Exhibit 5. The Acting STC denied equitable relief under programmatic relief on McStay Brothers late filed 2023 CCC-576 part D through H for Rye with the intended use of forage and grain.

B 2026 – Crop Table Review

1) Sorghum – Dual Purpose

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 4 to review and make a determination on County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum – Dual Purpose as recommended in the table below.

2026 STO recommended yield and price

County	Type	IU	Ir/ Ni	UOM	CEY	Price	Organic Yield	Transitional Yield	Organic Price
Baca		FG	N	TON	1.10	131.17			
Baca ¹		SG	I	TON	17.38	RMA			
Bent		FG	I	TON	2.61	131.17			
Bent		GR	I	BU	20.00	5.08			
Bent		GR	N	BU	13.00	5.08			
Bent		SG	I	TON	16.96	RMA			
Bent		SG	N	TON	2.91	RMA			
Crowley		FG	I	TON	2.11	131.17			
Crowley		FG	N	TON	0.69	131.17			
Crowley		SG	I	TON	15.63	RMA			
Crowley		SG	N	TON	2.91	RMA			
Dolores		FG	I	TON	1.46	131.17			
Kiowa		FG	N	TON	0.82	131.17			
Kiowa		GR	N	BU	13.00	5.08			
Las Animas		FG	I	TON	1.41	131.17			
Las Animas		FG	N	TON	0.71	131.17			
Las Animas		GR	I	BU	20.00	5.08			
Las Animas		GR	N	BU	13.00	5.08			
Otero		FG	I	TON	3.30	131.17			
Otero		SG	I	TON	18.38	RMA			
Otero		SG	N	TON	2.91	RMA			
Prowers		FG	I	TON	1.97	131.17			
Prowers ¹		SG	I	TON	17.38	RMA			

Intended Use Key: CB=cannabidiol, DE= dry edible, FB=fiber, FG=forage, FH=fresh, GR=grain, NT=non-table, OL=oil, PR=processed, SD=seed, SG=silage, SO=sod, TB=table

1-Sg IU, Land physically located in Baca/Prowers is covered under RMA Silage Sorghum policy, NAP only covers out of county land.

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 4), the Acting STC approved County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum – Dual Purpose as presented and shown above for the 2026 NCT.

2) Sorghum Forage

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 5 to review and make a determination on County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum Forage as recommended in the table below.

2026 STO recommended yield and price

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
Adams	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.12
Adams	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.79
Adams	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.67
Adams	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.60
Adams	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.40
Adams	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.78
Alamosa	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.95
Arapahoe	ALU	FG	I	TON	91.81		1.87
Arapahoe	ALU	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.79
Arapahoe	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.74
Arapahoe	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.81
Arapahoe	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.14
Arapahoe	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.51
Arapahoe	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		1.91
Arapahoe	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.63
Baca	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.67
Baca	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.25
Bent	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.04
Bent	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.00
Bent	CAN	SG	I	TON	31.08		11.42
Bent	CAN	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
Bent	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.85
Bent	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.13
Chaffee	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.83
Cheyenne	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.48
Cheyenne	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.83
Conejos	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.70
Costilla	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.01
Crowley	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.22
Crowley	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.98
Crowley	SWT	SG	I	TON	31.08		7.11
Crowley	SWT	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
Custer	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.87
Dolores	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.15
Dolores	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.59
Dolores	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.05
Elbert	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.67
Elbert	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.55
El Paso	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.60
El Paso	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.39

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
El Paso	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.36
El Paso	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.75
Fremont	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.23
Fremont	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.06
Huerfano	ALU	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.44
Huerfano	ALU	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.92
Huerfano	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.03
Huerfano	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.89
Huerfano	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.60
Huerfano	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.61
Huerfano	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.68
Huerfano	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.97
Kiowa	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.12
Kiowa	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.02
Kiowa	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.40
Kiowa	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.89
Kiowa	SWT	SG	I	TON	31.08		9.83
Kit Carson	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.12
Kit Carson	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.91
Kit Carson	CAN	SG	I	TON	31.08		11.42
Kit Carson	CAN	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
Kit Carson	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.67
Kit Carson	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.67
Kit Carson	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.40
Kit Carson	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.64
Kit Carson	SWT	SG	I	TON	31.08		9.83
Kit Carson	SWT	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
La Plata	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.89
La Plata	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.68
La Plata	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.46
La Plata	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		0.46
Las Animas	ALU	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.84
Las Animas	ALU	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.99
Las Animas	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.37
Las Animas	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.91
Las Animas	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.06
Las Animas	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.77
Las Animas	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.64
Las Animas	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.98
Lincoln	ALU	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.30
Lincoln	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.10

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
Lincoln	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.01
Lincoln	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.61
Lincoln	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.74
Lincoln	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.37
Lincoln	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.92
Logan	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.58
Logan	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.13
Logan	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.85
Logan	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.71
Logan	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.08
Mesa	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.88
Montezuma	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.17
Montezuma	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.87
Montezuma	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.75
Montezuma	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.11
Morgan	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.13
Morgan	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.75
Otero	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.73
Otero	SWT	SG	I	TON	31.08		11.29
Otero	SWT	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
Phillips	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.77
Prowers	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.81
Prowers	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.00
Prowers	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.36
Prowers	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.11
Pueblo	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.57
Pueblo	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.05
Pueblo	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.87
Pueblo	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.90
Rio Grande	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.49
Saguache	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.36
Sedgwick	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.09
Sedgwick	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.89
Sedgwick	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.60
Sedgwick	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.63
Washington	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.93
Washington	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.00
Washington	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.46
Washington	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.73
Washington	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.24
Washington	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.96

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
Washington	SWT	SG	I	TON	31.08		9.83
Washington	SWT	SG	N	TON	31.08		3.01
Weld	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.48
Weld	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.96
Weld	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.13
Weld	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.77
Weld	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.71
Weld	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.06
Yuma	CAN	FG	I	TON	91.81		3.12
Yuma	CAN	FG	N	TON	91.81		1.00
Yuma	SUD	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.67
Yuma	SUD	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.84
Yuma	SWT	FG	I	TON	91.81		2.40
Yuma	SWT	FG	N	TON	91.81		0.99

Intended Use Key: CB=cannabidiol, DE= dry edible, FB=fiber, FG=forage, FH=fresh, GR=grain, NT=non-table, OL=oil, PR=processed, SD=seed, SG=silage, SO=sod, TB=table

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 5), the Acting STC approved County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum Forage as presented and shown above for the 2026 NCT.

3) Sorghum

Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist, presented the STC with the following information in Exhibit 6 to review and make a determination on County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum as recommended in the table below.

2026 STO recommended yield and price.

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
Adams	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.80
Adams	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		6.00
Arapahoe	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		14.00
Baca	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.30
Baca	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.80
Crowley	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.30
Crowley	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.80
Denver	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		16.00
Dolores	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		6.00
El Paso	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		6.00
Kiowa	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.27
Kiowa	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.80
La Plata	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.23

County	Type	IU	Ir/Ni	UOM	Price	Organic Price	CEY
La Plata	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.70
La Plata	GRS	GR	I	BU	RMA		9.00
La Plata	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		6.00
Las Animas	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.30
Las Animas	GRS	FG	N	TON	178.33		0.80
Lincoln	GRS	GR	N	BU	RMA		14.00
Otero	GRS	FG	I	TON	178.33		1.30

Intended Use Key: CB=cannabidiol, DE= dry edible, FB=fiber, FG=forage, FH=fresh, GR=grain, NT=non-table, OL=oil, PR=processed, SD=seed, SG=silage, SO=sod, TB=table

After reviewing the applicable policies and supporting documentation (Exhibit 6), the Acting STC approved County Expected Yield (CEY) and Average Market Price (AMP) on Sorghum as presented and shown above for the 2026 NCT.

4. Adjournment

There being no further business, the Executive Session was adjourned at 3:50 p.m. The next meeting is scheduled for February 10, 2026 via TEAMs.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

Colorado State Committee Meeting

Executive Session 01.06.2026

Exhibits

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